SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #50 · GENDER ROLES AND EXPECTATIONS

“My role is fixed, and I can't be more than that.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Family, culture, or church may tell us who we are allowed to be: the helper, the provider, the quiet one, the one who never leaves. Dreams are dismissed, abilities overlooked, and we shrink to fit. Eventually we forget what we wanted.

What Scripture teaches

“I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” God’s gifts are given to each person, and Paul says the body has many parts, each needed. “Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you.” Deborah was a prophetess who judged Israel, and Lydia led a business. God calls people in many ways. While Christians differ on some roles in marriage and church, nobody has the right to say you cannot grow in the gifts God gave you.

> *“For by the grace given me I say to every one of you: Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you”* (Romans 12:3).

Also see

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:13–14).

> “The body is a unit, though it is composed of many parts. And although its parts are many, they all form one body. So it is with Christ” (1 Corinthians 12:12).

> “Now Deborah, a prophetess, the wife of Lappidoth, was judging Israel at that time” (Judges 4:4).

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

Common self-statements

- This is all I am allowed to be.
- I cannot change what is expected of me.
- My dreams do not matter.
- It is too late to be anything else.
- I was born for this role only.
- People would not accept me in another role.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either in my role or out of place.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will not accept growth.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling stuck and concluding that I am.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I cannot change.

Challenging questions

- Who assigned my role, and was it God, family, or culture?

- What gifts do I have that my role does not use?
- What does Scripture say about gifts?
- What did I dream of before I learned to shrink?
- Where might I grow while remaining faithful to my commitments?
- Who could encourage me?

Truth summary

> God gave me gifts and calling beyond a label. I can honor my commitments and responsibilities while growing in the gifts He gave. My worth and my potential are not limited by someone else's script.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Will of God
- Guidance
- God, Creator

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My role is fixed, and I can't be more than that"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My role is fixed, and I can't be more than that." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who assigned my role?
- ☐ What gifts go unused?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What did I dream?
- ☐ Where can I grow?
- ☐ Who can encourage me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God gave me gifts.
- ☐ The body has many parts.
- ☐ I can think of myself with sober judgment.
- ☐ I can grow.
- ☐ My worth is not limited by a script.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 12:3**
  "For by the grace given me I say to every one of you: Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:13–14**
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **1 Corinthians 12:12**
  "The body is a unit, though it is composed of many parts. And although its parts are many, they all form one body. So it is with Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Growing in my gifts: Each week, note one step of growth.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Romans 12:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God gave me gifts, and I can grow in them.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name your gifts. Write what you do well.
- ☐ Revisit a dream. Write what you once hoped to do.
- ☐ Take one small step. Try a class, a skill, or a conversation.
- ☐ Seek encouragement. Ask a trusted friend or mentor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My role is fixed, and I can't be more than that": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Growing in my gifts
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My role is fixed, and I can't be more than that.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You made me with gifts. Free me from scripts that shrink me. Show me how to grow faithfully and use what You gave me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.